Sai Suresh Macharla Vasu

Master's Student, Saarland University
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

AI safety and evaluation; personalized and memory-augmented AI; human–AI interaction; interdisciplinary approaches to AI safety

EDUCATION

Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany — Oct 2023 – Present
Master of Science in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence
Current Grade: 1.6

Anna University, Chennai, India — Aug 2017 – Aug 2021
Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Engineering
Final Grade: 8.92 CGPA (≈ 1.8 GPA on the German grading scale)

RESEARCH/ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

SPAR (Supervised Program for Alignment Research)
Research Fellow – Fall 2026 — Sep 2026 – Present

- Working on **Moral Shadowbanning**, studying whether conversational AI provides systematically different levels of helpfulness, honesty, or harmlessness to users perceived as having poor moral character.

CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security, St. Ingbert, Germany
Student Research Assistant – Trustworthy ML Group — Dec 2025 – Present

- Conducting research on **LLM reviewer bias**, studying how author identity, affiliation, and writing style influence LLM assisted peer-review outcomes.
- Ongoing Master's thesis on **long-horizon personalization via Personal Knowledge Graphs**, focusing on user memory, temporal updates, and adaptive conversational AI.

AI Safety Saarland Research Group, Saarbrücken, Germany
Research Fellow – AI Safety Saarland Incubator — Oct 2025 – Feb 2026

- Worked as a research fellow with Dr. Indira Sen on social biases in multimodal LLMs.

Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany
Teaching Assistant – ML Courses — Nov 2024 – Feb 2026

- Elements of Machine Learning (WS 24/25, WS 25/26)
- Machine Learning (SS 25)

Deutsches Forschungszentrum für Künstliche Intelligenz (DFKI), Saarbrücken, Germany
Student Research Assistant – Interactive Machine Learning Group — Jul 2024 – Nov 2025

- **AuditCopilot: Fraud Detection with LLMs** — interpretable tax anomaly detection surpassing traditional audit tests.

PUBLICATIONS

Justice in Judgment: Unveiling (Hidden) Bias in LLM-assisted Peer Reviews
Sai Suresh Macharla Vasu*, Ivaxi Sheth*, Hui-Po Wang, Ruta Binkyte, Mario Fritz
Findings of ACL 2026
https://aclanthology.org/2026.findings-acl.14/

Safe for Whom? Rethinking How We Evaluate the Safety of LLMs for Real Users
Manon Kempermann, **Sai Suresh Macharla Vasu**, Mahalakshmi Raveenthiran, Theo Farrell, Ingmar Weber
International Association for Safe & Ethical AI (IASEAI 2026)
https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/IASEAI/article/view/43033

AuditCopilot: Leveraging LLMs for Fraud Detection in Double-Entry Bookkeeping
Md Abdul Kadir, **Sai Suresh Macharla Vasu**, Sidharth S. Nair, Daniel Sonntag
NeurIPS 2025 Workshop on Generative AI in Finance
https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.02726

ACADEMIC SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Reviewer, NeurIPS 2026 2026
Evaluations & Datasets Track; AI4GOOD Workshop; PALM Workshop.

Co-organizer, AI Safety Saarland – Advanced Fellowship Summer Semester 2026
Supported the organization of an advanced AI Safety Saarland fellowship, including coordination, session planning, and hosting reading groups and invited talks.

Student Volunteer, ACL 2026 San Diego, USA
Association for Computational Linguistics July 2026
Selected as a student volunteer and received a complimentary conference registration waiver worth USD 800.

AWARDS

Saarland Scholarship for International Students Saarbrücken, Germany
StudienStiftungSaar & Saarland Ministry of Finance and Science SS 2025 (€1,000) · SS 2026 (€1,200)
Awarded for outstanding academic performance during the M.Sc. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence at Saarland University.

President Scout Award, Indian Scouts and Guides (Pfadfinder) New Delhi, India
Indian Scouts and Guides; presented by former President of India Dr. Pranab Mukherjee Dec 2016
National-level scouting distinction recognizing leadership, community service, discipline, and citizenship.

REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Mario Fritz
Faculty, CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security

Dr. Ruta Binkyte
Senior Researcher, AI Ethics & Safety Research
German Research Center for Artificial Intelligence (DFKI)

Ivaxi Sheth
PhD Researcher, CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security